Blake Newton (Newt)

Clinical Mental Health Counselor (M.A., Dec 2026) | License-eligible MHC | Levantine Arabic

+1 (828) 361-2724 | Nantahala, NC — relocating to New York City, early 2027 | blake.newton12@gmail.com | blakenewton.me

SUMMARY

Trauma-focused counselor finishing a CACREP-accredited M.A. in Clinical Mental Health Counseling (December 2026). Trained in EMDR and EMDR 2.0, with 840+ practicum and internship hours (280+ direct) using EMDR, CBT and ACT. Intermediate Syrian (Levantine) Arabic speaker with refugee aid work in Erbil, Iraq, private refugee sponsorship, and volunteer work with refugee and immigrant communities in Raleigh-Durham. Committed to culturally responsive, trauma-informed care for Arab, Middle Eastern, North African, Muslim and South Asian (AMENAMSA) communities.

CLINICAL SKILLS

- ✧ Trauma-Informed Care
- ✧ EMDR & EMDR 2.0
- ✧ CBT & ACT
- ✧ Assessment & Treatment Planning
- ✧ Clinical Documentation
- ✧ Cross-Cultural Communication

EXPERIENCE

Student Intern (Practicum + Internship) | Leeke Magee Christian Counseling Center, New Orleans, LA *May 2025 – May 2026*

- Carried a caseload of 6–10 adult clients (ages 18–76) presenting with anxiety, depression, PTSD and OCD, completing 280+ direct client hours (840+ total)
- Provided trauma-informed individual counseling using EMDR, EMDR 2.0, CBT and ACT
- Conducted intake assessments and built individualized, goal-oriented treatment plans
- Completed timely clinical documentation and coordinated scheduling and case management
- Participated in weekly individual and group supervision

Receptionist | Leeke Magee Christian Counseling Center, New Orleans, LA *June 2025 – August 2025*

- Managed client check-in, waitlist and records with strict confidentiality

REFUGEE & IMMIGRANT WORK

Private Sponsor | Welcome Corps (U.S. Department of State refugee sponsorship program) *January 2025 – Present*

- Co-sponsored the resettlement of a refugee from Iraq with family members; raised $3,000 for initial resettlement costs
- Arranged Social Security and benefits enrollment, healthcare, DMV visits, transportation, and job search
- Providing ongoing practical support and friendship beyond the formal sponsorship period

Volunteer, Refugee Aid & Community Integration

The Summit Church, Refugee Outreach & Care Program (Raleigh, NC) *February 2024 – December 2024*
All Nations Soccer and World Relief Durham (Durham, NC) *March 2024 – May 2024*
MRDS (Erbil, Iraq) *October 2023 – November 2023*
Global Gates (Queens, NY) *May 2019 – June 2019*

- Made home visits and drove refugee families to medical and agency appointments
- Helped adults find jobs, provided informal Arabic interpretation, and co-hosted weekly community dinners
- Built trust across cultures and language barriers through careful listening and attention to unspoken needs and non-verbal cues

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Barista | Rarebird Emporium, Murphy, NC *August 2026 – Present*

- Built rapport with a wide range of regular customers in a busy café

Whitewater Raft Guide | Rolling Thunder Rafting Company, McCaysville, GA *May 2026 – August 2026*

- Calmed anxious guests and built their confidence while keeping sound judgment in fast-changing, safety-critical conditions

EDUCATION

M.A., Clinical Mental Health Counseling (CACREP-accredited), New Orleans Baptist Theological Seminary *Exp. Dec. 2026*
B.S., Environmental Science: Quantitative Energy Systems, University of North Carolina, Chapel Hill, NC *2021*
Summer Arabic Intensive (MSA & Levantine), Middlebury College Summer Language Schools, Bennington, VT *2024*
Arabic Immersion Course, Maraheb Institute, Amman, Jordan *2022*

CREDENTIALS & TRAINING

License-eligible MHC upon graduation; will apply for New York MHC-LP *Dec. 2026*
EMDR, EMDR Support Network, New Orleans, LA (2025); **EMDR 2.0,** Enhancing Trauma Treatment Institute, Online (2026)
Gottman Method Couples Therapy – Level 1 & 2, Gottman Institute, Online *In Progress*
Story-Informed Trauma Therapy Foundations Training, SITT Central, Online *In Progress*

LANGUAGES

English: Native | **Arabic:** Intermediate conversational Syrian (Levantine); low elementary MSA | **French & German:** High elementary